rules may include defining the acceptable range of numeric values, specifying required text or characters, or limiting selections to a predefined list of values. By implementing data validation, errors can be minimized, and the consistency and reliability of worksheet data can be ensured.

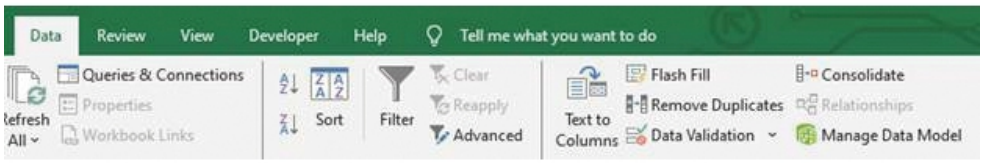
For instance, you can restrict a cell to only accept numbers within a designated range or specific values from a predefined list. To configure data validation, simply select the cells you wish to constrain, navigate to the Data tab, and choose Data Validation.

Furthermore, data validation allows for the creation and customization of error messages that prompt when attempting to input invalid data into a cell. This feature is valuable for error prevention and serves as a reminder of specific data and cell requirements.

ENTER DATA VALIDATION

Excel offers provides various data validation options to enhance the accuracy and consistency of data entered into cells. Below are the steps to follow to add data validation to an Excel sheet:

1. Choose the cell or cell range where you want to add data validation.
2. Select the *Data* tab in the ribbon menu and click the *Data Validation* button.



3. In the *Settings* section of the *Data Validation* window, choose the type of validation to apply from the *Allow* drop-down list. Some of the most popular options are:

    - ***Integer:*** Allows you to enter only whole numbers.
    - ***Decimal:*** Allows you to enter only decimal numbers.
    - ***List:*** Allows only values from a predefined list to be entered.
    - ***Date:*** Allows you to enter only dates.